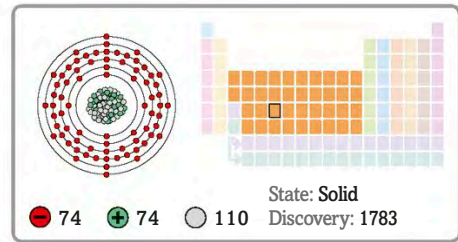


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Tungsten



Forms

This dark, metallic mineral contains tungsten and iron.



This mineral is the main source of pure tungsten.



Pure tungsten is a hard, grey metal.

Cylinder of pure tungsten refined in a laboratory



Uses

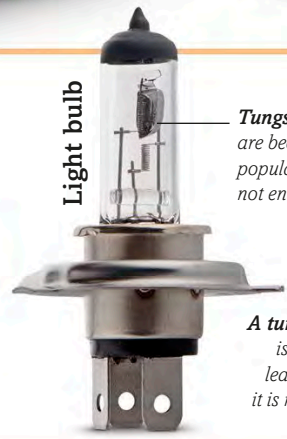
Drill bit



This drill bit has a coating of tungsten carbide, which protects it from damage.

Tungsten pigments were in use in Chinese porcelain 350 years ago.

Light bulb



Tungsten filaments are becoming less popular as they are not energy-efficient.

A tungsten sinker is preferred to a lead one because it is not poisonous.



Tungsten has the highest melting point of any metal: it turns to liquid at a searing 3,414°C (6,177.2°F). It is a very dense metal, and its name comes from the Swedish phrase for “heavy stone”. This metal is usually obtained from the mineral **wolframite**. A compound called

tungsten carbide is used to harden objects such as **drill bits**. Tungsten’s high melting point allows it to be used in the filaments of **light bulbs**. This element is also useful in producing weights, such as **sinkers** used with fishing lures.